border with Lebanon, to create a buffer that would end the PLO artillery's ability to lob shells at will on Israelis living in Galilee, in northern Israel.

The Israeli invasion provoked an angry reaction from Leonid Brezhnev. In the first in a series of exchanges between us via the Washington-Moscow cable "hot line," Brezhnev accused the United States of, at worst, complicity in the attack and, at least, advance knowledge of it. "The facts indicate," he said, "that the Israeli invasion is a previously planned operation, whose preparations the U.S. must have known about." I responded that while we believed Israel had the right to defend its northern borders, we did not support the invasion of Lebanon. I called his claim of prior knowledge of the invasion "totally without foundation."

"At the same time," I said, "I am compelled to point out that your government bears no little responsibility for the current crisis in the Middle East by its failure to support the Camp David accords and to use your influence on Syria and PLO" to stabilize the situation in Lebanon.

In Paris, I dictated a message to Begin appealing to him to withdraw his forces from Lebanon, and we joined in voting for a UN resolution calling for Israel's withdrawal and a cease-fire. After encountering little resistance north of the border, however, Ariel Sharon's tanks and troops continued their advance, and he apparently decided that Israel now had a historic opportunity to drive the PLO completely from Lebanon. The Israeli Defense Forces moved on Beirut, then expanded the war dramatically—and engaged a new enemy—with attacks on Syrian missile sites in the Bekaa Valley.

What had started (according to Begin and Sharon) as a limited operation designed only to enhance the security of the Israelis who lived near their country's northern border had suddenly been transformed into a campaign to wipe out